APPROVED ON OCTOBER 21, 2026
BY THE BOARD OF COUNTY COMMISSIONERS
AT THE WEEKLY BUSINESS SESSION

County Administration Workshop: October 15, 2026
1:30 p.m. – Board of Commissioners Conference Room
Attending: Commissioners Ron A. Smith; Colene M. Martin; Gary L. Richardson; and Nikole Guzman, Recorder

Chair Ron Smith called the meeting to order at 1:30 p.m.

1. **Declaration of Potential Conflicts of Interest**

   Commissioners Richardson, Martin, and Smith each declared no potential conflicts of interest.

2. **Department Business**

   a. **Community Development – Building Safety**

      1. **Out of State Travel Authorization**

Frank Wharregard, Building Official, and Ron Todd, Deputy Building Official, presented a request for out-of-state travel authorization for the department's Commercial Plans Examiner to attend the International Code Council (ICC) Annual Business Meeting in Nashville, Tennessee. Mr. Wharregard explained that she serves as Secretary-Treasurer of the Southern Oregon Chapter of ICC and President-Elect of the Oregon Permit Technicians Association, which is paying her airfare, lodging and registration. Of the $3,675 total cost of the trip, the County is asked to cover only $395 in per diem meals from the Building Safety Fund. He noted that ICC has asked her to speak on a panel about the career path from permit technician to building official. He also explained that Oregon adopts the ICC model codes as the State specialty codes, so participation gives Southern Oregon a voice in code development.

Mr. Wharregard stated that the meeting provides continuing education, networking with peers across the state and country, and renewed motivation for staff, and that feedback from local customers can be carried to the state organization on behalf of Southern Oregon. The Board noted the history behind building codes, observing that codes developed with input from fire officials, manufacturers, designers and contractors have prevented tragedies that go uncounted. Mr. Wharregard added that the department's role is to work with customers to comply with State requirements rather than to dictate to them, and that staff would report back to the Board after the trip.

Commissioner Martin moved to approve the out-of-state travel authorization as presented. Commissioner Richardson seconded the motion. Upon roll call: Commissioner Richardson - Yes; Commissioner Martin - Yes; Commissioner Smith - Yes. Motion carried 3-0.

3. **Board Business**

   a. **Resolution No. 2026-039 – In the Matter of Affirming Compliance with State and Federal Law and Requesting That the State of Oregon Address Counties' Federal Funding and False Claims Act Exposure**

The matter was previously considered and Resolution No. 2026-039 was approved at the Legal Counsel Update held earlier that day. No further action was taken.

4. **OTHER**

None heard.

5. **ADDITIONAL SUBJECT MATTERS FROM COMMISSIONERS/ANNOUNCEMENTS:**

None heard.

Chair Smith adjourned the County Administration Workshop at 1:40 p.m.

Convening as the Governing Body of the 4-H/Extension Service District: October 15, 2026
2:00 p.m. – Board of Commissioners Conference Room

Attending: Commissioners Ron A. Smith; Colene M. Martin; Gary L. Richardson; and Nikole Guzman, Recorder

Chair Ron Smith convened the Board as the Governing Body of the 4-H/Extension Service District at 2:00 p.m.

1. **Declaration of Potential Conflicts of Interest**

   Commissioners Richardson, Martin, and Smith each declared no potential conflicts of interest.

2. **4-H/Extension and Service District**

   a. **Grant Application**

Commissioner Richardson presented the 4-H/Extension Service District grant application for agricultural education. He explained that the District has $30,000 available for agricultural education grants, that the Public Information Officer will advertise the program to interested groups, and that the Board would review the applications received and decide which, if any, to award. He envisioned funding three or four projects but noted that a single worthy project could receive the full $30,000. Commissioners agreed that eligibility should extend to youth organizations such as FFA and 4-H as well as adult agricultural education, and could include facility or capital projects tied to agricultural education, and suggested approaching the Farm Bureau as a potential partner.

Commissioner Martin stated that applicants will need clear criteria, including a maximum request amount, eligible age groups and project types. She noted that the application prepared by Legal Counsel contains no insurance requirement and asked that applicants provide a certificate of insurance naming the County and holding it harmless, as was required for the Economic Development grant program, along with a final report on accomplishments. Commissioners noted that the application states submission does not create a contract and that a contract would be negotiated with any selected applicant, where such terms can also be included. The Board agreed to return the application to Legal Counsel to add an insurance clause.

Commissioner Richardson moved to approve the 4-H/Extension Service District grant application as presented, amended to have Legal Counsel add an insurance clause. Commissioner Smith seconded the motion. Upon roll call: Commissioner Richardson - Yes; Commissioner Martin - Yes; Commissioner Smith - Yes. Motion carried 3-0.

Following the vote, the Board set the application period as November 1 through November 30, 2026, and agreed that the program would be announced by press release and posted on the County website, with the posting location to be determined with the Public Information Officer. Commissioners noted that the Economic Development grant application should carry the same insurance requirement and would be referred to the Finance Director.

Chair Smith adjourned the meeting at 2:17 p.m.